Demo Help Center: Troubleshooting Articles

Document type: Knowledge-base article set

Audience: Non-technical users of a fictional web application

Version: 1.0

Status: Independent portfolio demo

Scope note: *"WorkBoard" is a fictional task-tracking web application used for this writing sample. The interface names and behaviours below are illustrative. Verify them against a real application before publishing as product support content.*

Help Center overview

This sample contains three short support articles. Each article starts with a recognizable symptom, offers low-risk steps first, and explains when to contact support.

Article 1: I cannot sign in to WorkBoard

Applies to: WorkBoard web sign-in

Estimated time: 3–5 minutes

Symptoms

You enter your email address and password, but WorkBoard does not open your workspace. You may see an error message or return to the sign-in page.

Before you begin

- Confirm that you are using the correct WorkBoard website for your organization.
- Do not share your password or verification codes with anyone.
- If your organization manages your account, you may need its administrator to restore access.

Steps to resolve the problem

1. **Check the email address.** Confirm that you entered the email address associated with your WorkBoard account.
2. **Check the password.** Make sure Caps Lock is not enabled and that you have not included an extra space.
3. **Use the password reset option.** Select **Forgot password?** if it is available, then follow the instructions sent to your registered email address.
4. **Check your inbox.** Look for the reset message in your inbox and spam or junk folder. Use only the most recent reset link.
5. **Try a fresh browser session.** If sign-in still fails, open a private or incognito window and try again. This can help identify a browser-session issue.
6. **Check service status.** If your organization provides a status page, check whether sign-in is currently affected by an outage.

Security warning: *Support staff should not ask you to send your password or one-time verification code.*

Contact support if

- You no longer have access to the registered email address.
- The password reset email does not arrive after you have checked spam or junk.
- You see a message that your account is locked or disabled.
- You suspect someone else has accessed your account.

When contacting support, include the exact error message, approximate time of the failed attempt, browser name, and device type. Do not include your password or verification code.

Resolution check

You have resolved the issue when you can sign in and see the expected workspace.

Article 2: My changes are not appearing in WorkBoard

Applies to: Editing a task in the fictional WorkBoard application

Estimated time: 3–5 minutes

Symptoms

You change a task title, description, or status, but the new value does not appear after you leave the task or refresh the page.

Steps to resolve the problem

1. **Check for a save indicator.** Look for a confirmation such as **Saved** or a message that the update is complete.
2. **Check your connection.** Confirm that your device is online and that other websites load normally.
3. **Wait briefly.** Some applications need a moment to send changes to the server. Avoid clicking Save repeatedly while the first request is processing.
4. **Reopen the task.** Navigate away and return to the task to check whether the update persisted.
5. **Refresh only after checking the save state.** If the application shows that changes are still saving, do not refresh yet; you could lose unsaved edits.
6. **Check permissions.** If only certain fields cannot be changed, your account may not have permission to edit them.
7. **Try another browser session.** If the issue continues, reopen the application in a private or incognito window. If the issue disappears, a cached page or browser extension may be involved.

If your changes are still missing

- Copy any unsaved text to a safe local draft before retrying.
- Record the task URL or task identifier, if it is safe to share with support.
- Note which field you changed and whether a save confirmation appeared.

- Contact support if the problem affects multiple tasks or continues in another browser session.

Caution: *Do not repeatedly submit the same action if the application appears slow. First check whether the change was already saved.*

Resolution check

The issue is resolved when the updated value remains visible after you reopen the task.

Article 3: I am not receiving WorkBoard notifications

Applies to: Browser and device notifications

Estimated time: 5 minutes

Symptoms

You expect an alert for a task assignment or update, but no notification appears.

Steps to resolve the problem

1. **Check notification settings in WorkBoard.** Confirm that notifications are enabled for the event you expect.
2. **Check browser permissions.** Open the browser's site settings for WorkBoard and confirm that notifications are allowed, if the application uses browser notifications.
3. **Check device settings.** Confirm that the operating system has not disabled notifications for the browser.
4. **Check Focus, Do Not Disturb, or quiet mode.** These settings may suppress alerts without changing the application's notification settings.
5. **Check the correct account.** If you use more than one account or workspace, confirm that you are viewing the account where the event occurred.
6. **Test with a new event.** Ask a teammate to assign a test task, or use a safe test event supported by your application. Confirm that the event meets the notification rules.
7. **Reopen the application.** If notifications still do not appear, close and reopen the browser, then test again.

Contact support if

- Notifications remain missing after you check both application and device settings.
- Only one notification type fails while others work.
- You can reproduce the issue with a new test event.

Include your operating system, browser and version, notification type, approximate event time, and the steps you tried. Do not include private task content unless support specifically needs it and you are permitted to share it.

Resolution check

The issue is resolved when a new test event produces the expected notification or the application clearly explains why the event does not trigger one.

Escalation checklist

Before opening a support request, collect:

- [ ] A short description of the problem.
- [ ] The steps that reproduce it.
- [ ] The expected result and actual result.
- [ ] The approximate time the problem occurred.
- [ ] Browser and operating-system details.
- [ ] The exact error message, if one appeared.
- [ ] The troubleshooting steps already attempted.

Remove passwords, verification codes, payment details, and other sensitive information from screenshots or logs before sharing them.

Editorial notes for portfolio reviewers

This article set demonstrates symptom-first headings, concise procedures, low-risk troubleshooting, explicit resolution checks, security cautions, and consistent escalation criteria. WorkBoard is fictional; these articles must not be presented as official documentation for a real product.

End of help-center sample